

Detailed Lesson Plans

Session 1-60-Minute Lesson Plan

Component	Details and Instructions
Session Title	Mapping Our Legacy: Appreciating the Past to Inform the Future
Module	Module 1: The Foundation: Understanding Ourselves & the Landscape
Facilitator	Jian
Duration	60 minutes
Learning Objectives	By the end of this session, participants will be able to: 1. Articulate at least two key values or strengths from the company's legacy. 2. Identify one practice from the past that may need to be adapted for future growth. 3. Contribute to a shared "Legacy Map" that connects past successes to future aspirations.
Session Description	This session creates a safe space to honor the company's history and the founder's vision. We will explore core values and past successes to build a foundation of mutual respect and identify which elements of our legacy are essential to carry forward and which might need to evolve.

Materials Needed	• Slide deck • Large poster paper or digital whiteboard (e.g., Miro) • Markers or digital sticky notes • "Legacy Interview" worksheet (handout)
Session Agenda	
Opening & Hook (10 min)	Activity: "Our Story in Objects" Instructions: Show 3-4 images that tell the company's story (e.g., first truck, old logo, an early team photo). Ask: "What one word comes to mind when you see these?" Facilitate a brief, positive discussion about the emotions and strengths these images represent.
Input & Guided Practice (35 min)	Part 1 - Input (10 min): "The Power of Legacy" Instructions: Briefly present the concept that a strong legacy is a foundation to build upon, not a cage to live in. Introduce the "Legacy Map" we will create together, with two columns: "Enduring Strengths" and "Practices to Evolve." Part 2 - Guided Practice (25 min): "Legacy Interviews" Instructions: Pair participants (e.g., a family member with a long-time manager). Using the worksheet, they interview each other about a past success, the values it demonstrated, and what it teaches us for the future.

	They then write their key insights on sticky notes for the shared Legacy Map.
Debrief & Reflection (10 min)	Activity: "Reading the Map" Instructions: Facilitate a group discussion by looking at the completed Legacy Map. Ask: "What patterns do we see?" "What surprises you?" "How does seeing our history laid out this way make you feel about our future?"
Application & Closing (5 min)	Activity: "My Commitment to Our Foundation" Instructions: Ask each participant to share one value from the "Enduring Strengths" column they are personally committed to upholding as the company moves forward. This ends the session on a unified, forward-looking note.

Session 2-60-Minute Lesson Plan

Component	Details and Instructions
Session Title	Difficult Conversations in the Workplace
Module	Module 2: The Engine: Emotional Intelligence for Difficult Conversations
Facilitator	Cameron

Duration	60 minutes
Learning Objectives	By the end of this session, participants will be able to... • Define emotional intelligence and active listening Examine the positive aspects of having difficult conversations in the workplace and how it creates a healthier work environment • Apply the concepts learned in a scenario based exercise on having a difficult conversation in the workplace
Session Description	This session will overview the concepts of emotional intelligence and active listening in relation to having a difficult conversation in the workplace.
Materials Needed	• Projector and Screen • Slide Deck • Difficult Conversation Journal Handout • Facilitator • Chairs • Space for breakout session
Session Agenda	
Opening & Hook (10 min)	Almost everyone in the room has had a difficult conversation at some point in their life - whether with a family member or a close friend. Seeing as we spend a majority of our time during the week, and some weekends, what makes it difficult to have a difficult conversation with a coworker?

Input & Guided Practice (35 min)	Part One (15 min) Instructions: Define emotional intelligence and active listening and relate how those skills are important to having a difficult conversation ~ ten minutes Instructions: Provide instruction on the benefits of having a difficult conversation and how it will help foster a healthier work environment ~ five minutes Part Two (15 min) Instructions: Participants will be split into pairs and be provided a scenario where one participant will be the one to start the difficult conversation that is about the other participant. After 5 minutes, the pairs will rotate to work with someone new and rotating roles. ~ 15 minutes Part Three (5 min) Participants will be provided with a difficult conversation journal to reflect on both roles and if they can relate the material to a real life scenario they are currently facing. ~ five minutes
Debrief & Reflection (10 min)	Instructions: Debrief on the course material and the practical exercise. Participants will be asked what was challenging about it, whether they employed the skills of emotional intelligence and active listening, and what other factors go into having a difficult conversation. Icebreaker: How was it? Does anyone feel weird? The first time I did this exercise, I found it hard to balance participating in the exercise without acting unnatural so I know these things can be awkward. Question 1 to the Group: What was challenging about the exercise? Was it easier or harder than you thought?

	Question 2 to the Group: Did anyone feel themselves employing emotional intelligence or active listening? Did it feel natural or forced? Question 3 to the Group: What other factors go into having a difficult conversation?
Application & Closing (5 min)	Instructions: Participants will be asked if they feel this business would benefit from people being confident enough to engage in difficult conversations.

Session 3-60-Minute Lesson Plan

Component	Details and Instructions
Session Title	The Transition Talk: A Structured Framework for Succession Conversations
Module	Module 3-The Bridge: Facilitating Constructive Dialogue
Facilitator	Eryu
Duration	60 minutes
Learning Objectives	By the end of this session, participants will be able to: Identify the four elements of an effective succession dialogue using the Structured Dialogue Framework (SDF), also known as the

	S.T.A.R. model (Setting, Tone, Approach, Resolution). ● Apply active listening and inquiry techniques to navigate emotionally charged leadership transition conversations. ● Develop a personalized “Transition Talk Plan” tailored to a real or simulated family leadership scenario.
Session Description	This session helps family leaders bridge awareness into action by practicing a structured framework for productive “Transition Talks.” Building on the emotional regulation and empathy skills from Module 2, participants will learn how to use dialogue tools that balance respect for legacy with open discussion of change. The goal is to enable honest, and forward-looking conversations that strengthen trust.
Materials Needed	Facilitator Materials ● Slide deck: “<i>Structured Dialogue Framework (SDF) / S.T.A.R. Model</i>” ● Timer or clock ● Whiteboard/markers or digital whiteboard (e.g., Miro, Jamboard) ● “S.T.A.R. Framework” visual handout Participant Materials ● “Succession Scenario Cards” (3 mini case prompts based on company roles) ● “Transition Talk Planner” worksheet ● Pen/paper or digital notes

Session Agenda	
Opening & Hook (10 min)	Activity: “The Conversation I’m Avoiding” • Ask participants to think of one real or potential conversation they’ve avoided related to leadership transition (e.g., suggesting operational changes to the founder or clarifying roles among siblings). • Prompt: <i>“What makes that conversation difficult?”</i> • Have participants share in pairs for 3 minutes, then summarize common themes (e.g., fear of disrespecting legacy, power dynamics, uncertainty). Purpose: Normalize discomfort and establish personal relevance.
Input & Guided Practice (35 min)	(Part 1: Input – 15 min) Mini-lecture + Discussion: • Introduce the Structured Dialogue Framework (SDF) for conducting constructive succession conversations, using the S.T.A.R. model as a practical tool: ○ S – Setting the Stage: Clarify purpose, choose timing and environment intentionally. ○ T – Tone of Respect: Express appreciation for past contributions. ○ A – Approach with Inquiry: Use open-ended, curiosity-based questions (“What do you envision for the next phase of the company?”).

	○ <i>R – Resolution Orientation:</i> <i>End with clear next steps or shared understanding.</i> ● <i>Demonstrate a short example comparing defensive talk vs. constructive talk.</i> ● <i>Highlight how EQ tools from Module 2 (self-regulation, empathy, active listening) support each step of the framework.</i> ● <i>Encourage participants to notice language that shifts from blame to collaboration.</i> <i>(Part 2: Guided Practice – 20 min)</i> <i>Activity: “Role-Play the Transition Talk”</i> ● Divide participants into triads (speaker, listener, observer). ● Provide each group with a <i>Succession Scenario Card</i>: ○ Scenario A: Second-generation leader proposing a new structure to the founder. ○ Scenario B: Founder responding to modernization efforts suggested by children. ○ Scenario C: General Manager mediating between siblings about leadership roles. ● Round 1: 5-minute dialogue using the S.T.A.R. model. ● Round 2: 2-minute feedback from observer using checklist (<i>Did they clarify purpose? Maintain a respectful tone? End with next steps?</i>) ● Rotate roles once so everyone practices each perspective.
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Debrief & Reflection (10 min)	<i>Group Discussion Prompts:</i> • <i>What felt most challenging when applying the framework?</i> • <i>How did empathy or tone influence the flow of conversation?</i> • <i>Which part of the S.T.A.R. process felt most natural or most forced?</i> <i>The facilitator captures 2–3 insights on board and links them back to leadership transition challenges in the case.</i>
Application & Closing (5 min)	<i>Activity: “My Next Conversation Plan”</i> • <i>Participants complete one line on their “Transition Talk Planner”:</i> ○ <i>“One upcoming conversation I will approach using S.T.A.R. is...”</i> ○ <i>“My first step will be...”</i> • <i>Invite 1–2 volunteers to share commitments.</i>

Session 4-60-Minute Lesson Plan

Component	Details and Instructions
Session Title	From Vision to Action: Drafting Our First 90-Day Transition Plan

Module	Module 4: The Blueprint: Co-Creating the Path Forward
Facilitator	Jian
Duration	60 minutes
Learning Objectives	By the end of this session, participants will be able to: 1. Define 2-3 key priorities for the first 90 days of the leadership transition. 2. Collaborate on assigning clear ownership for each priority. 3. Commit to one specific, immediate next step to launch the transition plan.
Session Description	This session translates the shared vision and improved communication from previous modules into a concrete, collaborative 90-day action plan. Participants will define key priorities, establish accountability, and make a collective commitment to moving forward, ensuring the leadership transition begins with clear, coordinated steps.
Materials Needed	• Slide deck • Large poster or digital whiteboard titled "Our 90-Day Transition Blueprint" • Markers or digital sticky notes • "90-Day Priority Planner" worksheet (handout) • "My First Step" commitment cards

Session Agenda	
Opening & Hook (10 min)	Activity: "The Headline" *Instructions: Ask participants: "Imagine it's 90 days from today. The local business journal is writing a story about our successful first steps in this transition. What is the one-sentence headline?" Share headlines to create energy and a shared picture of success.*
Input & Guided Practice (35 min)	Part 1 - Input (10 min): "The Power of the First 90 Days" *Instructions: Briefly present a framework for a 90-day plan, focusing on 1) Quick Wins (build momentum), 2) Key Relationships (solidify trust), and 3) Strategic Foundations (initiate long-term changes). Introduce the "Our 90-Day Transition Blueprint" poster.* Part 2 - Guided Practice (25 min): "Building Our Blueprint" *Instructions: Using the "90-Day Priority Planner" worksheet, participants will brainstorm individually and then work as a group to agree on 2-3 top priorities for each category. They will write these on sticky notes and place them on the shared Blueprint poster, assigning an "owner" for each one.*
Debrief & Reflection (10 min)	Activity: "The RACI Check" Instructions: Facilitate a discussion on the completed Blueprint. For key priorities, ask: "Who is Responsible? Accountable? Consulted? Informed?" This ensures clarity and buy-in, surfacing any potential overlaps or gaps in ownership.

Application & Closing (5 min)	Activity: "My First Step Commitment" Instructions: Distribute "My First Step" cards. Ask each participant to write down one specific action they will complete within the next week to advance the plan. Have each person read their commitment aloud to the group, creating a powerful, accountable close.
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